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UAE Presidential Court

PRESIDENT OFFERS CONDOLENCES TO EMIR OF QATAR

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan yesterday offered his condolences to Sheikh Tamim Bin Hamad Al Thani, Emir of Qatar, on the passing of his father Sheikh Hamad Bin Khalifa Al Thani. During a visit to Lusail Palace in Doha, Sheikh Mohamed also extended his heartfelt condolences to the Al Thani family and the people of Qatar, praying that God grant the deceased eternal peace and give his loved ones strength and comfort. Sheikh Tamim expressed his appreciation to the UAE President for his sincere and fraternal sentiments towards Qatar and its people following their loss.

Delhi court nulls Alhind tender for Indian consular services

Will BLS, SGIVS return as court says incumbents 'may be permitted'?

DUBAI

BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

The chaos over India's passport, visa and attestation services in the UAE thickened further yesterday, after the Delhi High Court quashed the tender awarding Alhind Tours and Travels LLC the new Indian Consular Application Centres.

Ruling on a batch of petitions by rival bidders who had challenged the tender scoring, the court found the techni-

cal evaluation behind Alhind's selection could not be legally sustained. The court nullified the award, not just for the UAE, but for identical outsourcing contracts in Kuwait, Singapore and Canberra, heard together.

Fresh tenders

The court also directed the Indian government to issue fresh tenders for all four missions within one month, with instructions to conclude it "at the earliest."

On who runs the centres meanwhile, the judgment says incumbent providers "may be permitted" to continue until a new operator is chosen.

This leaves the decision to the missions rather than mandating it. Neither the Indian Embassy nor the Indian Con-

sulate had issued a statement by the time of publication.

The uncertainty adds to a tangle that has already disrupted a government service used heavily by the UAE's 4.5 million-strong Indian community.

Alhind's 16 centres, meant to replace longtime providers BLS International and SGIVS Global Services from July 1, never opened after the tender was challenged, forcing the embassy and consulate to run services directly for the first time in 17 years.

With yesterday's ruling, that stopgap has no clear end date for applicants relying on these centres for passport renewals, police clearance certificates and attestation.

SEE ALSO P4

US STEPS UP IRAN STRIKES AS HORMUZ TENSIONS RISE

UAE condemns Iran attacks on Gulf states

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The US dramatically escalated its military campaign against Iran yesterday, launching fresh air strikes and reimposing a naval blockade on Iranian ports, while Tehran vowed to keep the Strait of Hormuz closed and warned that no country in the region would be allowed to export oil and gas if the blockade continued.

The latest escalation dealt a major blow to last month's interim agreement, which had paused hostilities and opened a 60-day window for negotiations over Iran's nuclear programme. Iranian Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi said the renewed US blockade had "in a way, dismantled" the Islamabad memorandum reached between the two sides.

'Wave of strikes'

US Central Command said it carried out a "wave of strikes" targeting military sites allegedly used by Iranian forces to



US President Donald Trump warned that the campaign could intensify further, saying bridges and power plants could become targets next week.

attack commercial shipping in the Strait of Hormuz. The strikes hit defence and missile positions.

US President Donald Trump warned that the campaign could intensify further, saying bridges and power plants could become targets next week unless Tehran returned to negotiations. "You better make a deal, or you're not going to have anything left," Trump said.

Iran's Revolutionary Guards responded by declaring that the Strait of Hormuz would remain closed "until the United States ends its acts of aggression".

The conflict again spilled across the Gulf, with missile alerts sounding in Bahrain and Kuwait while Jordan said it intercepted Iranian missiles. Iran

claimed responsibility for attacks targeting the three countries.

Unacceptable escalation

The UAE condemned in the strongest terms Iran's renewed missile and drone attacks on Bahrain, Kuwait and Jordan, describing them as an unacceptable escalation and reaffirming its support for the security of Gulf states.

Speaking at the GCC-EU High-Level Forum on Regional Security and Cooperation in Brussels, UAE Minister of State Lana Nusseibeh also condemned attacks on commercial shipping and the use of the Strait of Hormuz as leverage.

"Targeting commercial shipping or using the Strait of Hormuz as a tool of economic coercion or blackmail is unacceptable," she said. "Such actions amount to piracy and pose a direct threat to regional stability, the security of its peoples and global energy security. Ultimately, our shared goal is to achieve enduring peace, stability and security in the Gulf and across our wider regional neighbourhood."

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WORLD CUP

Mbappe remains in Golden Boot race with a match still to go | P15, 16



IN FOCUS

Why UAE hotel breakfast buffets are impossible to resist | P8-9

Final tower of Chelsea Residences by DAMAC launched

Follows sell-out success across first five towers of the world's first football-branded residence

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

DAMAC Properties, the largest private real estate developer in the UAE and the Middle East, has launched the sixth and final tower of Chelsea Residences by DAMAC, following the exceptional sell-out performance of the first five towers.

Developed in partnership with Chelsea Football Club, the landmark project at Dubai Maritime City has seen strong demand from investors and end users, reinforcing the appeal of its waterfront location, branded residential proposition and lifestyle-led design.

The launch of the final tower now presents the last opportunity to own an apartment within the world's first football-branded residence.

"Chelsea Residences by DAMAC brings together an iconic global football brand, a prime waterfront setting and DAMAC's signature approach to luxury living," said Amira Sajwani, Managing Director, DAMAC Properties.



■ **TOP:** The project is developed in partnership with Chelsea Football Club

■ **RIGHT:** Chelsea Residences by DAMAC has the UAE's only rooftop football pitch



"With the launch of the final tower, investors have a rare opportunity to be part of a distinctive seafront community defined by panoramic sea views, wellness-led amenities and a lifestyle inspired by performance, leisure and resort-style living," she added.

As of 2025, Dubai leads the global branded residences market, with strong growth in transaction volumes of 26 per cent year-on-year

and growth in value of 51 per cent year-on-year. Prices command a significant premium, going as much as 64 per cent over non-branded units.

A UNIQUE PROPOSITION

Against this backdrop, Chelsea Residences by DAMAC offers a unique proposition, combining branded real estate, all sea-view apartments and curated amenities centred around football, wellness and resort-style living.

Chelsea Residences Tower C has a limited number of units available for sale, including one-bedroom, two-bedroom and three-bedroom residences. Prices start at Dh2.56 million, with sizes starting from 827 square feet.

Apart from the unobstructed views of the sea and the Dubai skyline, residents also enjoy access to several branded amenities including the UAE's only rooftop football pitch, the stunning blue-sand beach inspired by the team colours, and the Beach Club.

Having delivered more than 50,000 homes and another 8,800 to be delivered in 2026 across Dubai, DAMAC is committed to creating lifestyle-driven communities that elevate everyday living into an immersive experience.

- In association with DAMAC